

What We Need From You

A checklist of the content, photos and permissions we need to finish the new website.

Thank you for trusting us with the new Kintsugi Station website. The design and pages are built, and some parts use temporary text and sample photos for now. To replace them with the real Kintsugi Station, we need the items below. Most of them are quick answers or photos you already have on your phone.

Items marked **ESSENTIAL** are needed before the website can go live. Items marked **IF AVAILABLE** make the site stronger, but we can launch without them. If you don't have something, just tell us and we will plan around it.

How to send things to us

- **Answers:** reply by email or WhatsApp, or write them on this PDF and send it back.
- **Photos and videos:** please share them through a **Google Drive** (or Dropbox) folder in their **original size**. WhatsApp and Facebook shrink photos and make them look blurry on large screens. If you must use WhatsApp, send them as a **Document**, not as a photo.
- **Folders:** if you can, name folders by topic, for example "Pool", "Views", "Team", "Guests", "History".
- **You don't need to send everything at once.** The Essential items first, then the rest as you find them.

Our promise about people

Every photo of a real person (you, your team, and your guests) will be a real photograph. We will never create or edit a picture of a real person with AI, and we will never write a quote in someone's name. Everything shown about a real person will be something they said or approved.

SECTION 1

Business Details

The website currently shows sample contact details. Please confirm or correct each one.

☐	Phone and WhatsApp number The number guests should call or message. Tell us if WhatsApp uses a different number.	ESSENTIAL
☐	Email addresses The address for general questions and the address for bookings (they can be the same).	ESSENTIAL
☐	Exact location The full address and a Google Maps pin (in Google Maps, tap the villa, then Share, and send us the link).	ESSENTIAL
☐	Directions and travel times The site says “25 minutes from Kandy Railway Station” and “airport transfers from Colombo on request”. Are these correct? Anything else useful, e.g. road access or parking?	ESSENTIAL
☐	Website address (domain) Do you already own a domain name you want to use (e.g. stationvillas.lk), or should we help you choose one?	ESSENTIAL
☐	Logo Your logo in the best quality you have. Ideally the original design file (AI, EPS, SVG or PDF) from your designer. If you don't have a logo, tell us.	ESSENTIAL
☐	Tourism registration Your Sri Lanka Tourism Development Authority (SLTDA) registration number, and any awards or certificates (e.g. Tripadvisor Travellers' Choice, Booking.com awards). These build trust with guests.	IF AVAILABLE
☐	Languages spoken Which languages you and your team speak with guests (e.g. English, Sinhala, Tamil, German).	IF AVAILABLE

SECTION 2

Social Media and Booking Platforms

Please send the link (or the page name) for every platform where Kintsugi Station or Station Villas appears. We will link to them from the website, and pull real reviews from them.

☐	Instagram Link or @username, or tell us if you don't have an account.	ESSENTIAL
☐	Facebook Link to your page, or tell us if you don't have one.	ESSENTIAL
☐	TikTok, YouTube or any other social account If you have one.	IF AVAILABLE
☐	Booking platforms Airbnb, Booking.com, Agoda, Expedia or any others you list on. Links to each listing.	ESSENTIAL

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|--------------------------|---|------------------|
| ☐ | Review sites
Google Business profile (Google Maps reviews) and Tripadvisor, if you are listed. | ESSENTIAL |
| ☐ | How guests should book
Should guests book directly with you (form, email, WhatsApp), through a platform, or both? | ESSENTIAL |

SECTION 3

The Villa and Your Stays

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| ☐ | One villa or two?
The new website presents one private villa . Your current website offers Avalon Villa (sleeps 6), Villa Acland (sleeps 2) and both together (sleeps 8). How would you like the new site to present them? This affects the rates, the photos and how we credit guest reviews. | ESSENTIAL |
| ☐ | Rates
Your nightly rates in USD (and LKR if you want). Tell us about any low and high season rates, minimum stays, and what the price includes (breakfast, taxes, service charge). The site shows “from USD 650” for now. | ESSENTIAL |
| ☐ | Rooms and capacity
Number of bedrooms, bed types, bathrooms, and the maximum number of guests (adults and children). | ESSENTIAL |
| ☐ | House rules
Check-in and check-out times, cancellation policy, children, pets, smoking, events or parties. | ESSENTIAL |
| ☐ | Please confirm these things the website currently says
Private chef (Sri Lankan and international food) • Daily Ceylon tea ritual • Infinity pool • Private stone bath • Open-air pavilion • Teak master bedroom • Private tea terrace • Personal concierge for trips around Kandy • Free tea tasting for direct bookings. Please cross out anything that isn't true, and add anything we missed. | ESSENTIAL |

SECTION 4

Facilities

The main features guests should know about. For each one, please send a few good photos (see Section 6).

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| ☐ | Major facilities
For example: swimming pool, garden, terrace or balcony, dining area, living room, kitchen, library, yoga or meditation space. Tell us what makes each one special (size, view, history). | ESSENTIAL |
| ☐ | Everyday comforts
Wi-Fi, air conditioning or fans, hot water, parking, power backup, laundry, TV, safe, mosquito nets. | ESSENTIAL |
| ☐ | Food
What meals you serve, whether breakfast is included, and the cost of lunch or dinner. Any signature dishes? | ESSENTIAL |
| ☐ | Services and experiences
Airport and station transfers, driver or tuk-tuk, guided walks, cooking classes, massage, tea estate visits, and anything else you arrange for guests. | IF AVAILABLE |

SECTION 5

Views and the Surroundings

The things guests remember most, beyond the facilities: the setting of the villa.

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| ☐ | What guests can see from the villa
Sunrises, sunsets, mountain ranges, morning mist, the city lights of Kandy at night, the lake, forest, birds or wildlife. Tell us which view guests talk about most, and the best time of day to see it. | ESSENTIAL |
| ☐ | Photos of these views
See Section 6 for tips on taking them. | ESSENTIAL |
| ☐ | Places nearby you recommend
Your favourite places near the villa, with rough travel times (e.g. Temple of the Tooth, Peradeniya Botanical Gardens, Hantana hikes, tea estates, restaurants). A short list is enough. | IF AVAILABLE |

SECTION 6

Photos and Videos of the Villa

Most photos on the website today are **temporary sample images**. We want to replace them all with real photos of Kintsugi Station, so guests see exactly what they will get.

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| ☐ | Professional photos
Any photos taken by a professional photographer, for example for Airbnb or Booking.com. Please tell us who took them so we can credit them if needed. | ESSENTIAL |
| ☐ | Every space of the villa
The outside of the villa, entrance and gate, each bedroom, bathrooms, living and dining areas, pool, garden, terrace. | ESSENTIAL |
| ☐ | Views
Sunrise, sunset, mountains, mist and night views from the villa (Section 5). | ESSENTIAL |
| ☐ | Food and small details
Breakfast, tea being served, flowers, old furniture, textures and the kind of details that show the character of the house. | IF AVAILABLE |
| ☐ | Videos
Any videos you already have: drone footage, a walk through the villa, the pool, the view, guests enjoying the stay. Short clips are fine. We can use them in the page headers and on social media. | IF AVAILABLE |

Tips if you take new photos on a phone

- Take photos in **daylight** with lights on inside, or at golden hour for views (the hour after sunrise or before sunset).
- Hold the phone **sideways (landscape)** for most photos, and take a few upright (portrait) too.
- Tidy each room first: beds made, no bags, towels or cables in view.
- Wipe the phone lens, and don't use filters or zoom.
- Send more rather than fewer. We will pick the best ones.

SECTION 7

Guest Reviews and Guest Photos

Real words from real guests are the most convincing thing on a hotel website. We have already found **10 reviews** on your current website (from guests such as Toby, David, Eva, Ala, and Tom & Hannah).

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| ☐ | Permission to reuse the 10 reviews from your current website
We show them word for word, never edited or rewritten, with the guest's first name and the month of their stay. | ESSENTIAL |
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| ☐ | Any more reviews you like
Copy or screenshot your favourite reviews from Google, Tripadvisor, Airbnb or Booking.com. For each one please include the reviewer's name , the month and year , and where it was posted . A photo of the reviewer is welcome but not needed. | ESSENTIAL |
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| ☐ | How to show guest names
First name only (e.g. "Eva, January 2025"), or also the country (e.g. "Eva, Germany")? Should we mention which villa they stayed in? | ESSENTIAL |
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| ☐ | Photos taken by guests
Photos guests have shared with you (on social media, by email or WhatsApp). We can only use a guest's photo if the guest has agreed. See the note below. | IF AVAILABLE |
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| ☐ | Photos of you or your team with guests
For example, welcoming guests, dinners or farewells. Every guest who can be clearly recognised in the photo must agree to it being on the website. | IF AVAILABLE |

Asking a guest for permission

A short message to the guest is enough, and a reply by email or WhatsApp counts as permission. For example:

"Hi Eva, we loved having you at Kintsugi Station. We're building our new website and would love to include your photo (and your review). Would that be okay? We'd credit it as 'Eva, Germany'."

Please forward us the guest's reply along with the photo.

SECTION 8

The Founders and the History of the Villa

The website has a section called **The Founders** and space for a short **history timeline**. We have already used the photo of you both and the text from your current About page: *"We are an English-Lankan / American couple living in Sri Lanka since 2011..."*

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| ☐ | Your names
Exactly as you'd like them shown on the website (e.g. first names only, or full names). | ESSENTIAL |
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| ☐ | Permission to use your photo from the current website
Or a different photo you prefer. A clear photo of you both, ideally at the villa. | ESSENTIAL |
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| ☐ | The story of the villa, in a few lines
What the building was before (who built it, when, what it was used for), how you found it, what you restored and kept, and why you called it Kintsugi Station. A few sentences or a voice note is fine. We will write it up and send it to you for approval. | ESSENTIAL |

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| ☐ | Key dates | ESSENTIAL |
| For example: when you moved to Sri Lanka (2011), when you found the house, when restoration started and finished, and when the first guests arrived. Approximate years are fine. | | |
| ☐ | Before and after photos | IF AVAILABLE |
| Old photos of the house before or during the restoration. These fit the kintsugi idea perfectly: something old and broken, repaired and made beautiful. Even blurry old photos are valuable here. | | |
| ☐ | Company history | IF AVAILABLE |
| Your other properties (e.g. Villa 234 in Trincomalee), and whether the new website should mention them. | | |

SECTION 9

Your Team

The website has a section called **The People Behind Your Stay**. Guests mention Prasanna, Rasu and Manjula in almost every review, so this is a very strong part of the site. We currently use the team photo from your current website, showing three people at the gate.

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| ☐ | Which staff members to show | ESSENTIAL |
| List everyone you would like on the website. For each person: the name they'd like used and their job title (e.g. Prasanna, General Manager). | | |
| ☐ | Who is who in the team photo | ESSENTIAL |
| In the team photo on your current website: is it Prasanna on the left, Rasu in the middle and Manjula on the right? We won't put a name under a face until you confirm. | | |
| ☐ | Each person's permission | ESSENTIAL |
| Please check with each person that they are happy to have their name, photo and quote on the website. | | |
| ☐ | A professional photo of each person | IF AVAILABLE |
| A clear photo from the chest up, in good light, ideally at the villa. A good phone photo works well. If you have a professional photo, even better. | | |
| ☐ | A short quote from each person | IF AVAILABLE |
| One or two sentences in their own words, e.g. <i>Prasanna, General Manager: "Our hospitality is..."</i> . It can be in Sinhala or Tamil. We will translate it and send the translation back for them to check. | | |

Questions that help your team think of a quote

- What does good hospitality mean to you?
- What do you enjoy most about looking after guests here?
- What is one thing every guest should do in Kandy?
- What is your favourite moment of the day at the villa?

SECTION 10

A Welcome from Prasanna

A short welcome from Prasanna on the home page, next to the Book Your Stay button, makes the villa feel personal before guests even arrive. Either of these works:

**A short text quote**

ESSENTIAL

One or two sentences, in his own words, e.g. about how he looks after guests.

**Or a short video (20 to 45 seconds)**

IF AVAILABLE

Prasanna welcoming guests to Kintsugi Station, filmed on a phone.

Tips for filming the video

- Hold the phone **sideways**, at eye level, on a stand or held steady by someone else.
- Film outside or near a window in soft light, with a nice part of the villa behind him.
- Choose a quiet spot (no fans, traffic or music), and stand close to the phone so the sound is clear.
- Speak naturally. It doesn't need to be perfect, and a few takes are fine. We will choose the best one and add subtitles.

NEXT STEPS

What Happens After You Send This

We will add your content to the website as it arrives. Before the site goes live, we will send you a preview link so you can check every page, name, quote and photo. Nothing about a real person will be published without your approval.

If anything in this list is unclear, or you are not sure what to send, just ask. A quick call or a voice note is often the easiest way.

Thank you,

The Senyx team